

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Khaled Fahad

Address: 21 St James' Road Sutton SM1 2BB

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:Representation in Support of Application DM2025/01591

I am writing to strongly support application DM2025/01591. As a local resident and a Muslim, I believe this center is essential for fostering community cohesion, tolerance, and mutual understanding in our neighborhood.

1. Design and Visual Impact

The proposed development is scaled appropriately for the site. It fits the local character and offers a clear visual improvement over the current site classification.

2. Environmental Benefits & Softscaping

The inclusion of softscaping will greatly improve the streetscape. The focus on biodiversity and urban greening is a welcome change that benefits everyone in the area.

3. Community Value

As a Muslim committed to neighborly care, I know our community will be a dedicated asset to Belmont. We are a diverse group in urgent need of a local space to serve our religious and social needs.

4. Transport and Parking

The Transport Statement confirms 269 street parking spaces nearby. With a peak capacity of 134 spaces, the site can easily accommodate visitors without placing a burden on local residents.

5. Noise and Operating Hours

Unlike the current 24-hour ambulance station, this center will operate within defined daytime and early evening hours. This transition represents a significant reduction in noise pollution for neighbors.

6. Local Services

The center will host educational classes, wellbeing sessions, and interfaith events. These services provide a positive "social anchor" for Belmont, moving the site from an industrial feel to a community-focused one.

7. School Traffic Coordination

Prayer times naturally fall outside of the morning and afternoon school run windows. The facility operators are committed to scheduling events to ensure there is no conflict with local school traffic.

8. Environmental Standards

The application fully addresses all technical requirements, including drainage, flood risk, energy conservation, and the preservation of local trees.

9. Health and Wellbeing

Having a local place of worship is vital for our mental health and sense of belonging. It provides a safe, respectful space for the elderly to socialize and stay active.

10. Social Value and Global Context

There is a legitimate, unmet demand for a facility dedicated to the followers of the Abrahamic faiths in this area. In a time of rising geopolitical tension, providing a space for harmony and social value is more important than ever.

Why this Mosque is Necessary for the Area

Beyond the technical merits, this facility is a necessity for the following reasons:

Local Accessibility: Currently, local Muslims especially the elderly and those without cars must travel long distances to worship. A local facility reduces travel time and carbon footprints.

Youth Engagement: The area lacks dedicated spaces for minority youth. This center will provide a safe environment for mentorship and positive community participation.

Crisis of Loneliness: Many residents in Belmont face social isolation. A community hub provides a "third space" outside of work and home to build friendships across different backgrounds.

Integration: A visible, open, and transparent community center is the best tool for dispelling myths and building a truly integrated, peaceful neighborhood.

I believe this proposal aligns perfectly with planning policy and offers a net positive for all residents. I urge the Council to grant planning permission.